

Issue 51 - Codexa New User Tutorial

This PDF summarizes the documentation change added to PR #53. The goal was to give first-time users a clear first-run path for installing Codexa, wiring one repository, checking readiness, and using the normal Codexa plan/edit/review loop.

Before	README Quick Start gave install and init commands, but did not route new users to a complete tutorial.
After	README Quick Start links to a new start-to-finish guide at docs/guides/new-user-tutorial.md .
New artifact	This PR now also includes docs/guides/issue-51-new-user-tutorial-summary.pdf for reviewer-friendly before/after context.

What changed

- Added a newcomer tutorial with install paths, Codex CLI and Claude Code wiring, readiness checks, the everyday edit loop, success criteria, and troubleshooting.
- Linked that tutorial from the README Quick Start section so a new user has an obvious next step after the setup commands.
- Kept examples project-agnostic with /path/to/project placeholders and no machine-local workspace details.

Validation used before this PDF follow-up

- git diff --check
- npm run privacy
- npm run check: typecheck, source hygiene, release-path checks, privacy, Claude Code smoke tests, build, and 289 Vitest tests across 19 files
- Codexa post-edit review: no unplanned files against the saved scope; inspect remained because docs context quality was medium and new Markdown headings are expected symbol deltas

Screenshots in the next pages were generated from the actual origin/main README and the current PR branch content rendered in a local browser.

Before Screenshot

README Quick Start on origin/main. Users saw commands, but no tutorial handoff.

PR #53 BASELINE

Before: Quick Start stopped at commands

No start-to-finish tutorial link was present in the Quick Start path.

Quick Start

Codexa requires Node.js 22 or newer.

Install from npm:

```
npm install -g @mirnoorata/codexa
```

Or work from a checkout:

```
git clone https://github.com/mirnoorata/codexa.git
cd codexa
npm install
npm run build
npm link
```

Wire Codexa into another repository:

```
codexa init /path/to/project # Codex CLI: .codex/config.toml + hooks
codexa init /path/to/project --claude # also writes a repo-root .mcp.json for Claude Code
codexa session-start /path/to/project
```

After `codexa init`, the target repository gets a repo-local `.codex/config.toml` entry that lets Codex discover the Codexa MCP server automatically, and with `--claude` a repo-root `.mcp.json` so Claude Code discovers the same server (only the codexa entry is managed; other servers in an existing `.mcp.json` are preserved, and malformed JSON aborts the write). When init runs from an evictable npx cache, generated configs pin `npx -y @mirnoorata/codexa@<version>` instead of the cache path so they keep working after a cache prune.

After Screenshot

README Quick Start on PR #53. The new tutorial link is visible immediately after the setup commands.

PR #53 CHANGE

After: Quick Start points to the tutorial

The README now routes new users to a complete first setup walkthrough.

Quick Start

Codexa requires Node.js 22 or newer.

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npm install -g @mirnoorata/codexa
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Or work from a checkout:

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cd codexa
npm install
npm run build
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```

For a start-to-finish first setup, see the

[new user tutorial](#).

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Tutorial Coverage Screenshot

The new guide gives first-time users one concrete path through setup, readiness, edit-loop use, and troubleshooting.

ADDED GUIDE

New tutorial coverage

The new guide gives first-time users one concrete path through setup and the edit-lifecycle loop.

1. Install

Shows npm and source-checkout install paths plus version verification.

2. Wire a repo

Explains Codex CLI and Claude Code setup without editing source files.

3. Check readiness

Defines session-start freshness, parser errors, dirty files, and doctor.

4. Run the loop

Walks through brief, change-plan, edit, post-edit-review, and test-plan.

5. Verify success

Frames what evidence new users should expect after a Codexa-guided edit.

Troubleshoot

Covers PATH, missing index, missing MCP tools, wrong repo, and heuristic output.

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